

A SOCIAL MEDIA MYTH, MEASURED

“End with a question” doesn't work.

It is a common tip for government social media. On our data, it doesn't lift engagement.

What the numbers say →

THE MYTH

0.96x

Posts that end with a question do slightly worse than the same page's usual post. They come out ahead on only 36% of pages.

369,000 local-government Facebook posts, Jul 1 to Sep 23, 2026.
Each page compared with its own other posts (median).

WHAT DOES DRAW COMMENTS

Ask plainly, or celebrate someone.

Posts that ask outright (“tell us”, “comment below”, “share your photos”) get 1.5× the comments. Posts that congratulate a person get 3×.

Comments, each page vs. its own other posts.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Give people a reason to answer.

A question mark is not an invitation. A clear ask, or someone to cheer for, is.

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